



[Reference](#) > [Postman API reference](#) > [Postman MCP Server](#)

Set up a local Postman MCP server

✦ Ask a question | Copy page | View as Markdown | More actions ▾

The local server is based on STDIO transport and is hosted locally on an environment of your choice. STDIO is a lightweight solution that's ideal for integration with editors and tools like Visual Studio Code. Install an MCP-compatible VS Code extension, such as GitHub Copilot, Claude for VS Code, or other AI assistants that support MCP. The local server only supports API key authentication (with a Postman API key or Bearer token).

The local server only supports API key authentication (with a Postman API key or Bearer token).

Before you begin

Local servers only support API key authentication, so you'll need to generate a [Postman API key](#). For an overview of the server, remote versus local, and when to use each configuration, see [Use AI agents with the Postman API](#).

Supported configurations

The local server supports the same [tool configurations](#) as the remote server—**Minimal** (default), **Code**, and **Full**—selected with a command-line flag. It also supports a local-only option:

Quiet — Suppresses `debug` and `info` logs in stderr and returns only `warn` and `error`.

Required for Windsurf users on Windows, where it avoids a stderr pipe buffer deadlock that causes the MCP initialize request to time out. Enable it alongside the **Minimal**, **Code**, or **Full** configuration.

Use the `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`), or set the `POSTMAN_API_BASE_URL` environment variable directly. By default, the server uses the `us` option.

To run the server as a Node application, install Node.js [before getting started](#).

[Pricing](#)[Enterprise](#)[Contact Sales](#)[Launch](#)

Claude Code

To install the MCP server in Claude Code, run one of the following commands in your terminal:

Minimal Code Full

```
$ claude mcp add postman --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=<POSTMAN_API_KEY> -- npx @postman/postman-mcp-server@latest
```

Cursor

Click the button to install the local Postman MCP server in Cursor:

[Add to Cursor](#)

Manual installation

To manually integrate your MCP server with Cursor and VS Code, create a `.vscode/mcp.json` file in your project and add one of the following JSON blocks to it. You can optionally include the `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`). Defaults to `us` (in the `args` array, specify it as `"--region", "eu"`).

Minimal Code Full

```
1  {
2    "servers": {
3      "postman-api-mcp": {
4        "type": "stdio",
5        "command": "npx",
6        "args": [
7          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
8        ],
9        "env": {
10         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "${input:postman-api-key}"
11       }
12     }
13   },
14   "inputs": [
15     {
```



18

`"description": "Enter your Postman API key"`

Visual Studio Code

Click the button to install the local Postman MCP server in VS Code:

[VS Code](#) [Install Server](#)

Manual configuration

You can manually integrate your MCP server with VS Code to use it with extensions that support MCP. Add the optional `--region` flag to specify the Postman API region (`us` or `eu`). Defaults to `us` (in the `args` array, specify it as `"--region"`, `"eu"`).

To create a manual configuration, create a `mcp.json` file in your project and add one of the following JSON blocks to it:

Minimal [Code](#) [Full](#)

```
1  {
2    "servers": {
3      "postman": {
4        "type": "stdio",
5        "command": "npx",
6        "args": [
7          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
8        ],
9        "env": {
10         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "${input:postman-api-key}"
11       }
12     }
13   },
14   "inputs": [
15     {
16       "id": "postman-api-key",
17       "type": "promptString",
18       "description": "Enter your Postman API key"
19     }
20   ]
21 }
```

[Pricing](#)[Enterprise](#)[Contact Sales](#)[Launch](#)

Minimal — `postman-api-mcp-minimal.mcpb`

Code — `postman-mcp-server-code.mcpb`

Full — `postman-api-mcp-full.mcpb`

For more information, see the [Claude Desktop Extensions](#) documentation.

Codex

To install the local server, use the API key installation method. Set the `POSTMAN_API_KEY` environment variable and invoke the MCP server using `npx`.

Minimal Code Full

```
$ codex mcp add postman --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=<POSTMAN_API_KEY> -- npx @postman/postman-mcp-server
```

Windsurf

To install the MCP server in Windsurf, do the following:

1. Click **Open MCP Marketplace** in Windsurf.
2. Enter “Postman” in the search text box to filter the marketplace results.
3. Click **Install**.
4. When prompted, enter a valid Postman API key.
5. Select the tools that you want to enable, or click **All Tools** to select all available tools.
6. Turn on **Enabled** to enable the Postman MCP server.



Windows users on Windsurf can encounter a startup timeout because too many startup logs fill the stderr buffer, which blocks the server before MCP initialization completes. Using the `--quiet` configuration suppresses those logs and avoids the issue.

Manual installation

Copy the following JSON config into the `.codeium/windsurf/mcp_config.json` file (to use `--quiet` with Code or Full, include it alongside `--code` or `--full` in the `args` array).



```
1  {
2    "mcpServers": {
3      "postman": {
4        "args": [
5          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
6        ],
7        "command": "npx",
8        "disabled": false,
9        "disabledTools": [],
10       "env": {
11         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
12       }
13     }
14   }
15 }
```

Antigravity

To install the MCP server in Antigravity, click **Manage MCP servers > View raw config**. Then, copy the following JSON config into the `mcp_config.json` file:

```
1  {
2    "mcpServers": {
3      "postman": {
4        "args": [
5          "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
6        ],
7        "command": "npx",
8        "disabled": false,
9        "disabledTools": [],
10       "env": {
11         "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
12       }
13     }
14   }
15 }
```

GitHub Copilot CLI

[Pricing](#)[Enterprise](#)[Contact Sales](#)[Launch](#)

```
$ /mcp add
```

Manual installation

Copy the following JSON config into the `~/.copilot/mcp-config.json` file:

Minimal [Code](#) [Full](#)

```
1  {
2      "mcpServers": {
3          "postman": {
4              "command": "npx",
5              "args": [
6                  "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
7              ],
8              "env": {
9                  "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
10             }
11         }
12     }
13 }
```

Gemini CLI

To install the MCP server directly in the Gemini CLI, run one of the following commands in your terminal.

Minimal [Code](#) [Full](#)

```
$ gemini mcp add postman npx -- -y @postman/postman-mcp-server --env POSTMAN_API_KEY=
<POSTMAN_API_KEY>
```

Gemini CLI extension

To install the MCP server as a Gemini CLI extension, run the following command in your terminal:

```
$ gemini extensions install https://github.com/postmanlabs/postman-mcp-server
```



To install the local Postman MCP Server in Kiro, click the install button for the version that you want to use:

Minimal	Code	Full
 Add to Kiro 	 Add to Kiro 	 Add to Kiro 

To install the Postman MCP server with Kiro powers, go to [Kiro Powers](#)  and navigate to **API Testing with Postman** in the **Browse powers** section. Then, click **Add to Kiro**.

Manual installation

To install the Postman MCP Server manually, do the following:

1. Launch Kiro and click the Kiro ghost icon in the left sidebar.
2. Add an MCP Server and select either **User Config** or **Workspace Config** to install the Postman MCP server.
3. Add the following JSON block to the `mcp.json` configuration file:

```
1  {
2      "mcpServers": {
3          "postman": {
4              "command": "npx",
5              "args": [
6                  "@postman/postman-mcp-server"
7              ],
8              "env": {
9                  "POSTMAN_API_KEY": "<POSTMAN_API_KEY>"
10             },
11             "disabled": false,
12             "autoApprove": []
13         }
14     }
15 }
```

Docker